

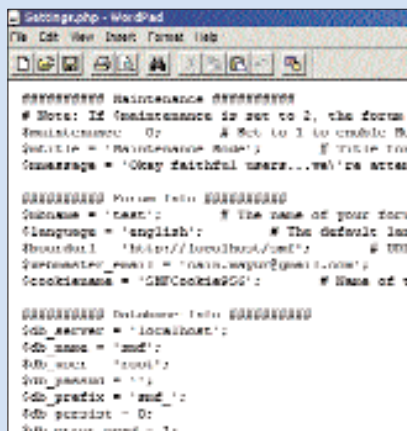
save your file in themes\images in your SMF directory. Note that you need to change the number of stars to one if you wish to use a single image, otherwise you will end up with five successive images for senior members. A neat trick is to have a specific image (like a black belt for administrators) for each member rank, which look more appealing than any number of stars!

Change The Agreement!

If you find the agreement that users see at the registration page drab, you can change it to your own version. Just edit agreement.txt to your liking—you can find this in the root of the folder where SMF is installed.

Oops! I Forgot My Password!

In case you ever end up forgetting your MySQL database password for SMF, you can find it using the settings.php file located in your SMF directory. Open it in Notepad and look in the 'database info' area where the



You can find your database password in the settings.php file

username, password, database name etc will be there. These should be the same settings that you entered when installing SMF.

Changing Smileys

If you don't like the default code for your smileys—say you'd rather have “:evil:” as a trigger than something like “>:),” open the subs.php file in the sources folder in your SMF directory. This option is located somewhere around the middle of the file; search for an entry called “parsesmileys” and you should get there.

See the smileyfrom and smiley2 functions? These are the ones you need to edit.

“smileyfrom” is what you will be entering to trigger the corresponding

GIF image just below it in the “smiley2” function.

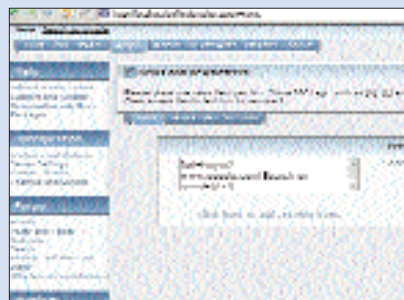
Read The News

To add spice to your forum, you can add news items, which appear at the top of your forum. They can be anything you want, or even URLs. PHP code will work here, too. For example, you can have a link saying “Click here” directing to www.google.com. Just use the following format to do so:

```
[url=http://www.anyurl.com]Your text[url]
```

For images, use an image host like ImageShack, which gives you a URL like this:

```
[img]http://img444.imageshack.us/img444/3977/clipboard01cz7.jpg[/img]
```



You can put in URLs for news. php code is also possible here

As mentioned, your PHP functions that you use to post in forums will work here.

Boring Without Add-Ons

It's worth noting that you can install additional packages quite fast by going to Packages in the admin page. The forum will usually update the page and enable you to install them directly without going through too much trouble. Just click on packages under “Main” in the admin page, click on the package you want to install, and click “install now” to immediately download and install the package to your forum.

Spy Game

A modification available at www.simpleremachines.org/community/index.php?topic=36793.0 allows you to track the activities of any user, showing you users' activities in full view. To install and use it, download the file, which in some cases may download as tracker.htm. Copy this file to your SMF folder, the same place where the Readme and SSL.php are located, and

rename tracker.htm to tracker.php. This should finish the install.

To view a user's log, simply enter “http://www.yoursite.com/yourforum/tracker.php”. You can now track any user's activity by simply entering the username in the text box. Again, this option is only available to administrators; should users try to gain unauthorised access to this file they will receive an error, which again, you can customize by opening the tracker.php file and searching for and editing this line:

```
echo “ERROR: You are not Army.ca Staff.”;
```

The “Army.ca staff” bit might vary depending on your SMF version. To find the line without any hassles type in “echo “ERROR”” without the quotes in the search box using your text editor.

Register Users Manually

You can manually register anyone through your admin page itself by clicking on “Registration” under the “members’ area”. This is useful when you have closed down registration for your forum and want to make a few exceptions. Note that you can also make the forum send an e-mail to the user with his username and password.

Spy On Moderators

You can keep track of any moderator actions executed by your moderator team or by yourself. Any actions exclusive to moderators can be logged after enabling “Log Moderation



The moderation log allows you to see all your moderator's activities

Actions” under “Features and Options”. This log can be viewed under “Moderation logs” in detail, including the action taken, the username of the moderator, and the IP address from which the action took place.

You can get SMF from www.simpleremachines.org. Happy admin-ing! ■
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